



MINI-GUIDE TO

MUSCLE GAIN



How many muscle fibers does the human body have? No matter what the answer is, it's sure to be fewer than the crazy number of muscle growth tips you'll find online! An abundance of information sounds great, but the downside is information overload—it's hard to know where to start.

Muscle growth is made even more complicated by the fact that beginners need very different and often more simple programming for best growth compared to advanced lifters. So the biggest lifters online might be giving out tips that apply to them, but won't be of much help to you if you are just starting out or even intermediate.

Below are some fundamental principles for muscle growth—science-based tips with some details on how things will change as you advance!

TIP #1 // TRAIN HARD.



Body mass is increased when you eat more food, but your body won't grow muscle with that food unless it has a *good reason*. Training hard with weights gives your body that reason and if you supply the extra food, muscle growth will happen!

So how do you “train hard” for muscle growth?

- Do enough sets to get a “pump” (tight swollen feeling) and feel tired in your target muscle groups each session
- Choose weights that will get you to within 1-4 reps from muscular failure after 5-30 reps
- Train the same muscle groups around 2-4 times a week
- Make sure you increase reps, sets, and or weight each week until a deload
- Deload every 4-8 weeks

Beginners should focus on basic compound movements like squat, bench, deadlifts, rows, and pulling movements—not much variation is needed. They should focus on good form and consistent lifting and should avoid going closer than two reps from failure until technique is very solid. They can usually lift less days per week and do less sets and still grow, unlike intermediate and advanced lifters who need to push the limits to keep growing.

We know that sounds like a tall order, but that’s why so few people are muscular...it’s tough work!

TIP #2 // EAT ENOUGH PROTEIN (AND FOOD IN GENERAL).



Your muscles are literally composed of protein, so if you don’t get enough of it, you can forget about muscle gains!

For the best results, aim for about 1g protein per pound of body weight — that means a 150 lb person would aim for 150 grams of protein every day. Ideally, spread that protein total evenly across 4-5 meals per day.

Your body also will not grow much muscle unless it has extra calories lying around. So, make sure you are eating at a surplus of calories while lifting to grow muscle more efficiently!

TIP #3 // SHARPEN YOUR TECHNIQUE.



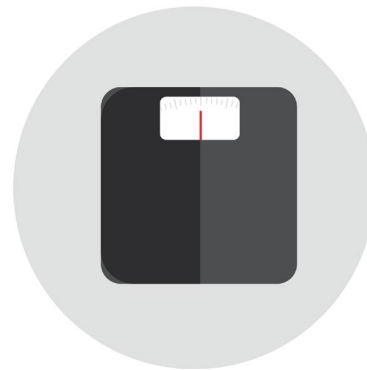
Good lifting technique allows you to stimulate your muscles as much as possible while minimizing your fatigue—allowing the most efficient muscle growth. Good technique is also very important for minimizing joint and connective tissue damage that can limit your lifting career and life.

To do this you should aim to...

- Have a full range of motion on most lifts;
- Control the descent by never letting gravity or momentum take the lead;
- And experiment with different hand and foot positions as well as body movements that'll make your target muscles feel the most tension and burn, without too much joint discomfort.

Beginners should be especially concerned with good technique as the habits they develop in their early lifting years will follow them through their career. Because beginners grow more easily, they can afford to spend time on technique, whereas an advanced lifter who has to relearn because of injury will be losing muscle growth time!

TIP #4 // WATCH THE SCALE.



Aiming for a weight gain of about 0.3% of your bodyweight per week is a great starting point. This means that if you weigh about 150 lb, you can plan to gain about half a pound per week, or about 2 lb per month.

Make sure you watch the scale, write down your daily weight, and review each week's average. If it's less than 0.3% of your bodyweight, you'll need to increase your food intake—especially your carbs and fats. If you're gaining more than the goal, you can ease up on the carbs and fats a bit.

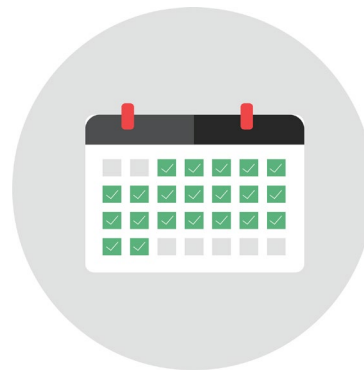
A muscle gain phase can last anywhere from a few to many months. When it comes to your diet, after a few months you may notice a dip in appetite and weight gain, as well as a rise in body fat. Don't panic, this is normal. At this point, take two weeks of easy training, eat and drink whatever you like (as long as you meet your protein targets). After an almost undetectable or even a [mini cut](#) to get rid of some body fat. This will help reset your appetite and allow you to continue gaining more muscle without pushing your body too hard.

Not sure when or how much you should increase/decrease your food intake? Don't worry — if you already have the [RP Diet Coach](#) app, as long as you're consistent with your weigh-ins and meal planning, the app will let you know when and how you should adjust your macros.

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Beginners can usually gain more muscle and less fat over time and therefore spend longer periods in a muscle gain phase. They remain more sensitive to lifting volume and can get more stimulus with less fatigue and therefore need less breaks than more advanced lifters.

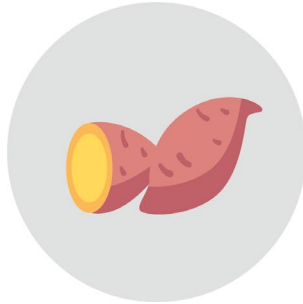
TIP #5 // TRAIN CONSISTENTLY.



We're sure that having a great training session feels awesome, but unfortunately, that single session grows almost an undetectable amount of muscle. In order to see visible gains, you'll need to go to the gym consistently and not make a habit of skipping workouts.

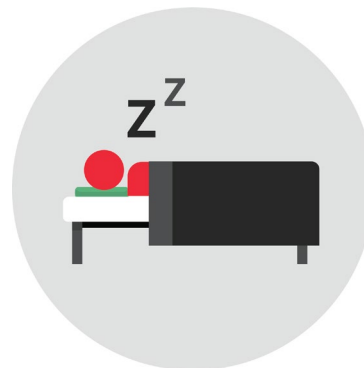
Do you remember that super muscular person that skipped workouts all the time? Neither do we.

TIP #6 // EAT HEALTHY.



You can train as hard as you want but in reality, if you're in poor health then you're going to struggle with muscle gains. Along with your hard training sessions, you'll need to make sure you eat lots of lean proteins, vegetables, fruits, whole grains, and healthy fats. Don't forget to stay active and get your steps in! Eating healthy will help you feel better, which is a great benefit in its own right, and it can fuel hard workouts to build even more muscle!

TIP #7 // SLEEP, DELOAD, RECOVER.



First, make sure you regularly get at least seven hours of sleep per night. Recovery is just as important as training for muscle growth. The only badge for "getting up earlier than your opponent" is less muscle!

Hard training for muscle growth has to get harder across weeks (as discussed above), but you cannot increase difficulty forever. If you did, your body would start to use all your extra calories for recovery from fatigue and not have any left for muscle growth. When you're so beat up from training that you stop being able to progress week to week, take what's called a "deload", where you cut your reps, weight, and number of sessions in half.

Yep, that's a big reduction, and exactly what your body needs to recover and prepare for more weeks of hard, growth-promoting training!

TIP #8 // ENJOY YOUR FOOD!



When you're eating to put on muscle, most of your food should be relatively health-promoting (whole, fresh foods). However, having a few fun meals per week can be motivating, help you gain, and won't harm your health. As long as you keep on your protein targets, enjoy the perk of a weight gain phase—some occasional tasty, calorie dense food!

If you like these tips and want to know more, our [YouTube channel](#), free extensive [guidelines](#), and [eBooks](#) can give you lots more insight. If you'd like a program that's easy to understand and gets dependable results, check it out [here](#). Or if you'd like a more advanced hypertrophy program, check these out ([male](#) / [female](#)).

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